

Allow Plenty of Space When Following a Motorcycle

The slightest contact can mean a spill or injury for the rider. Allow more following distance, at least four to six seconds, when following a motorcycle so the motorcyclist has enough time to maneuver or stop in an emergency. Stop a safe distance behind the motorcyclist at intersections, signals, or crossings. A full vehicle length is recommended to help prevent impact with the motorcycle should your vehicle suffer a rear end collision. In dry conditions, motorcycles can stop more quickly than a car, so being aware and alert at all times can help prevent a collision.

Special Note:
If you drive aware of motorcyclists in these situations, you can help make the streets and roads safer for everyone.

Texas Motorcycle Operator Training Program

The Texas Legislature created the Motorcycle Operator Training and Safety program in 1983 and moved its administration from DPS to TDLR in 2020. The Program's aim is to improve rider skills and reduce the number and severity of motorcycle crashes in Texas. A portion of each motorcycle license fee is used to support this program. The program develops curriculum and monitors motorcycle training classes throughout the state and promotes motorcycle safety and awareness through campaigns, exhibits, and materials.

Contact TDLR at <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/> for more information about motorcycle safety and training courses.

Share the Road with Light Rail

In recent years, light rail has been established in many major cities in Texas. As you travel these areas, you may notice these trains move along the streets just like other vehicles. Light rail is very quiet; and, in fact, quieter than most buses and cars. So whether you are riding a light rail or just walking or driving near the train or tracks, it's important to stay alert and observe the safety rules.

Table 24: Safety Rules for Light Rail

Action	Description
Stop	- Don't walk in front of, between, or behind a train. - Trains can't start or stop quickly regardless of traffic flow. - Do not drive, stop, or park your vehicle on the tracks. It's dangerous and illegal.
Look	- Cross the tracks only at designated crossings and only when it is safe. - Look both ways before crossing the tracks. Trains travel in both directions. - Obey all warning signs, flashing lights, signals, and crossing gates. A law enforcement officer will issue tickets to violators.
Listen	- Stay alert. Light rail is quieter than a bus or most cars. You may not hear a light rail coming. - Listen for train horns and signal bells. - Always follow instructions from a law enforcement officer.
Don't	- Never race a train, run in front of a train, or put anything on or near the tracks. - Never try to beat the train to a crossing. Even in a tie, you lose. - Never drive around crossing gate arms.

Share the Road with Bicycles

A bicycle is a vehicle. Any person riding a bicycle has all of the rights and responsibilities as a driver of a vehicle.

Rules for Motorists and Bicyclists

1. Bicyclists are not restricted to the right lane of traffic. One-way, multi-lane streets are one example of this. Another instance is when the bicyclist is changing lanes to make a left turn. The bicyclists should follow the same path any other vehicle would take traveling in the same direction.
2. A motorist should merge with bicycle traffic when preparing for a right turn. Avoid turning directly across the path of bicycle traffic.
3. Bicyclists are required to ride as far to the right in the lane as possible only when the lane can be shared safely by a car and a bicycle, side-by-side. Even then, there are certain conditions that allow a bicyclist to take the full lane.
 - a. The bicyclist is overtaking and passing another, vehicle proceeding in the same direction.
 - b. The bicyclist is preparing for a left turn at an intersection or onto a private road or driveway.
 - c. There are unsafe conditions in the road, such as fixed or moving objects, parked or moving vehicles, pedestrians, animals, potholes, or debris.
 - d. The lane is of substandard width, making it unsafe for a car and a bicycle to safely share the lane side-by-side. When this is the case, it is best for the cyclist to take the full lane, whether riding single file or two abreast.

Car-Bicycle Crashes

Be on the lookout for cyclists on the road, especially at intersections. The most common car-bicycle crashes caused by a motorist are:

1. A motorist turns left in front of oncoming bicycle traffic. Oncoming bicycle traffic is often overlooked or its speed misjudged.
2. A motorist turns right across the path of the bicycle. The motorist should slow down and merge with the bicycle traffic for a safe right turn.